Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers at Town Hall on Monday, November 18, 2019 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of Minutes

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Minutes of the regular, special and Closed Session meetings of Council held on October 15 & 16 and November 1, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions from the public regarding any matter on the agenda. There were no questions from the public.

5. Delegation and Petitions/Public Hearings

5.1 Ajax Public Library Bookmark Contest Winners

Susan Aiken, Community Engagement Associate, Ajax Public Library, noted that October 20-26th was Ontario Public Library Week and 2019 was the ninth year of the Ajax Public Library's Bookmark Contest. Ms. Aiken introduced the winners of this year's contest and thanked Council for the opportunity to recognize the contest participants. Mayor Collier, Donna Bright, Chief Librarian, and Doug Miller, Library Board Member, congratulated all of the winners and participants.

5.2 The Opioid Crisis: A Complex Multifaceted Health and Social Issue

Melissa Hutchinson, Program Manager, Durham Region Health Department, delivered a presentation regarding the Opioid Crisis in Durham Region. Ms. Hutchinson discussed history and risk factors, use of prescription opioids in Ontario, root cause of the crisis, multi-faceted nature of the issue, 2018 point-in-time count, social and genetic factors, public health mandate, Canadian drugs and substances strategy framework, Durham Region Opioid Response Plan, Opioid Information & Data System, benefits and best practices of a Needle Exchange Program, risks associated with community based needlestick exposure, HIV rates, public health services for prevention and early intervention, FCM recommendations of the mayor's task force on the Opioid Crisis in 2017, and the Association of Municipalities of Ontario recommendations.

Council members thanked Ms. Hutchinson for her presentation and asked questions regarding cumulative costs of the opioid crisis in Ontario, provincial and federal action to hold opioid producers accountable, causes of opioid addiction, number of annual opioid deaths in Durham Region, education and information provided to schools, costs and effectiveness of the Needle Exchange Program, and addiction and treatment services. Ms. Hutchinson responded to questions from Council Members and discussed provincial and national action, number of opioid-related deaths in Durham in the last three years, causes and source of addiction, school education programs, operation of the Needle Exchange Programs, and addiction treatment services provided in Durham.

With the consent of members present, correspondence item 9. 'Durham Region: Opioid Overdose Emergency' was advanced in the order of business.

Motion

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the correspondence received from the Region of Durham regarding the Opioid Overdose Emergency be endorsed.

CARRIED

5.3 **2019 Accessibility Advisory Committee Update**

Heather Steeves, Committee Vice-Chair, presented a summary report of the activities of the Accessibility Advisory Committee (AAC) for 2019. Ms. Steeves discussed the role of the AAC and current membership of the committee. Donna Mullings, Committee Vice-Chair, reviewed events and activities during the 2019 National AccessAbility Week and the #AccessAjaxTogether initiative. Rosanne Purnwasie, Committee Member, discussed engagement with Durham Regional Transit, #RespectTheSpace campaign, and other Committee involvement with Town initiatives. Committee members thanked Council for their continued support.

Council Members thanked all AAC Members for their dedication to accessibility in Ajax and asked questions regarding regulations for accessible parking spaces and enforcement of accessible parking space usage. Sarah Moore, Committee & Accessibility Coordinator, and Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services / Town Clerk, responded to questions from Council Members and discussed accessible parking requirements and enforcement.

5.4 **2019 Heritage Advisory Committee Update**

Bruce Balsdon, Heritage Advisory Committee Chair, presented a summary of the activities of the Heritage Advisory Committee (HAC) for 2019. Mr. Balsdon discussed the purpose and mandate of the Committee, public outreach, education and special events, identifying and evaluating heritage properties, proactive conservation and preservation, review and comment on planning applications, Ajax Archives acquisitions and exhibits, heritage governance, and recognizing and celebrating past and present residents. Council Members thanked Mr. Balsdon for the presentation and all HAC Members for their contribution to preserving the history and heritage of Ajax.

5.5 **2019 Town of Ajax Customer Satisfaction Survey**

David Forget, Manager, Quality, Customer Service & Special Projects, introduced Jodi Shanoff, Vice President, Consultation and Engagement at Environics Research, who delivered a presentation regarding the 2019 Town of Ajax Customer Satisfaction Survey. Ms. Shanoff discussed the methodology of the survey, satisfaction with municipal government, survey participants' greatest likes and dislikes, rating of community factors, most important issues facing Ajax today, satisfaction with Town services, attitudes towards tax increases, experience with Town staff, most effective way of communicating services, methods of contact with municipal departments, information sought from the Town, and drivers of overall satisfaction with the Town.

Council Members asked questions regarding the results of the survey, how the data will be used to improve Town services, significant changes in results from previous surveys, survey methodology, cost to complete the survey, and length of the survey. Ms. Shanoff and Mr. Forget responded to questions from Council Members and discussed use of the survey results, significant changes in results since the last survey, overall methodology and questions, and cost to perform the survey. Council Members thanked Ms. Shanoff and Mr. Forget for their presentation.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence item 7. for discussion.

Members discussed the motion received from the Municipality of Prescott regarding Provincial Consultation on the Transformation of Building Services in Ontario.

Motion

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the correspondence received from the Municipality of Prescott regarding Provincial Consultation on the Transformation of Building Services in Ontario be endorsed.

CARRIED

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the report dated November 18, 2019 containing Items of Correspondence be adopted.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

None

7.2 General Government Committee Report

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated November 11, 2019, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities dated November 18, 2019 as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1 2019 Town of Ajax Customer Satisfaction Survey

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Council receive the report entitled "2019 Town of Ajax Customer Satisfaction Survey" for information.

CARRIED

7.4.2 Envision Durham – Municipal Comprehensive Review Addendum to Town of Ajax Comments on the Growth Management: Urban System Discussion Paper in response to Pickering's Notice of Motion – An Age Friendly Affordable Housing Strategy

Council Members asked questions regarding the submission of comments and next steps. Geoff Romanowski, Acting Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members and discussed the Region's Municipal Comprehensive Review process and opportunities to submit comments on behalf of the Town.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

1. That staff's comments included as Attachment 1 to this Report be endorsed and submitted to the Region of Durham Planning and Economic Development Department as an addendum to the Town's comments on the Growth Management: Urban System Discussion Paper; and

2. That a copy of the comments be distributed to the Region of Durham, and all local Durham Region municipalities.

CARRIED

7.4.3 Interim/Internal Borrowing – Development Charges Financing

Council Members asked questions regarding the purpose of internal borrowing and the recommendations in the report. Julie Mepham, Acting Manager of Budgets and Accounting, responded to questions from Council Members and discussed the internal borrowing process and impacts of Bill 108 on development charge collection shortfalls.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

1. That Council approve the interim (temporary) borrowing up to a maximum of $9,900,000 from the Post Growth Reserve to fund the development charges projects in respect of which there is a 2019 Development Charge collection shortfall (the "DC Projects")

2. That The Regional Municipality of Durham (the "Region") be asked to approve the passing of a by-law authorizing the issuance of a debenture as internal borrowing, in the amount of $9,900,000 for the 2019 to 2024 forecasted Development Charges collection shortfall

3. That all costs associated with the issuance of the debenture and the interim (temporary) borrowing be funded from the Development Charges Reserve Fund

4. That the debenture issued as internal borrowing be funded from the Town's Post Growth Reserve

CARRIED

7.4.4 Ajax Public Library Board Update

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the report titled "Ajax Public Board Update" be received for information.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillors provided an update regarding matters before Durham Regional Council, including the opioid crisis in Durham Region, upcoming 2020 budget discussions, Ontoro Boulevard local improvement charges, Ontario Parasport Games, and addressing homelessness and affordable housing.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of November 18, 2019 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Collier

That the rules of procedure be suspended in order to introduce a motion without notice regarding Corporate Strategic Plan Alignment.

CARRIED (2/3rds)

9.1 Corporate Strategic Plan Alignment

Regional Councillor Crawford introduced a motion directing staff to identify on all future reports to Council how the contents of the report relate to Council's Strategic Plan. Council Members discussed the contents of the motion and considered whether the matter should be referred to staff for further study.

Referral Motion

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the matter be referred back to staff for review and to report back to the December 20th, 2019 meeting.

MOTION LOST

Recorded Vote:
In Favour: Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee
Opposed: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

Main Motion

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

WHEREAS a strategic plan identifies priorities and guides day-to-day decision making;

AND WHEREAS Council approved a new strategic plan for the 2018-2022 term in September, 2019;

AND WHEREAS the new 2018-2022 Ajax Strategic Plan – Stronger Together – identifies three focus areas, 21 goals and an aggressive 148 actions;

AND WHEREAS the strategic plan is a road map to ensure Town initiatives align with the focus areas, goals and actions of the plan;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT all Council reports include a new 'Relationship to the Strategic Plan' section; and

THAT staff identify how the report aligns to the 2018-2022 Ajax Strategic Plan in the new section by outlining the focus area, goal and action it supports.

CARRIED

9.2 Maternity and Parental Leave Top-up

Regional Councillor Lee introduced a motion regarding maternity and parental leave top-up for exempt employees of the Town. Council Members discussed the contents of the motion, attraction and retention of staff, estimated costs, Council's parental leave policy, comparable practices in Durham, and alignment with the Town's Strategic Plan and Mission Statement.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS The Town as an employer supports families and work-life balance, and is committed to breaking down barriers to gender equality in the workplace;

AND WHEREAS there is a significant financial cost to having children, as households experience a substantial reduction in household income during a maternity/parental work absence;

AND WHEREAS progressive policies around parental leave have been proven to encourage a more balanced sharing of childcare responsibilities among caregivers, and to help parents better manage the demands of employment and infant care;

AND WHEREAS paid maternity and parental leave programs allow parents time away from their job to care for their newborns with some level of earnings replacement;

AND WHEREAS, according to Statistics Canada, approximately one third of working mothers receive supplemental income from their employers while on maternity/parental leave;

AND WHEREAS the Town of Ajax strives to be an employer of choice, attracting and retaining diverse talent, and the best public servants in the market;

AND WHEREAS The Town's Diversity Policy states that, "*The Town is strongly committed to equity and diversity through its policies, procedures, service delivery, amenities and employment practices";*

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT staff be directed to provide a report to Council or the appropriate standing committee no later than March 2020, outlining the benefits and estimated cost impacts of introducing a parental leave top-up program for exempt employees.

MOTION LOST

Recorded Vote:
In Favour: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Dies, Regional Councillor Lee
Opposed: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Khan, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

10. By-laws

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law numbers 63 to 71-2019 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities, including Wards 1 and 3 community meetings, family skate, Santa Claus Parade, Audley Recreation Centre Phase 2 grand opening, Christmas in the Village, and the Mayor and Council Holiday Food & Toy Drive.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: J. Dies

That By-law number 72-2019 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on November 18, 2019 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

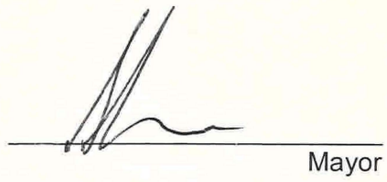
CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the November 18, 2019 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (9:30 p.m.)

CARRIED



Mayor



D-Clerk